Mike Woodcock

AI systems that survive production

Independent AI and machine learning consultant. Berlin, Germany, working remotely with clients in the US and Canada.
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Most AI pilots never reach production. The ones that do often arrive without evaluation, without cost control and without an owner. I am the person who takes a promising prototype and turns it into a service your team can run, measure and afford. I have done it as a hands-on engineer and as the head of the department that owned the outcome.

PROOF

As Head of AI and Engineering at SellerX, a Berlin e-commerce company with more than EUR 100M in annual revenue and over 100,000 products:

- **60% of covered support tickets resolved without a human**, more than 2,000 a month, at 99.9999% uptime.
- **Forecast error cut from 0.4 to 0.3 MAPE** with 70–80% of demand planning automated, replacing a four-planner manual process.
- **EUR 700K a year in overstock fees removed**, on a conservative 3–4% improvement against a EUR 15–20M fee base.
- **Company-wide generative AI adoption**, built on one governed platform for LLM access, retrieval, prompt management and evaluation.

Earlier, as principal ML engineer on camera perception at Kopernikus Automotive, since acquired by Ford, I raised throughput **from 20 to 200 frames per second** and scaled to **100+ concurrent camera streams**, shipping into Ford, Porsche, Mercedes-Benz, Volkswagen, BMW and Jaguar programs.

WHAT I DO

Agentic automation. LLM agents with retrieval over your own data, tool use, human-in-the-loop review and real evals, wired into the systems you already run. Support resolution, document intake and extraction, financial controlling copilots, operations and planning.

Deep learning and computer vision. Detection, segmentation, tracking, depth and video understanding, trained on your data and optimized until it runs in real time on the hardware you actually have. TensorRT, ONNX, Triton, DeepStream, CUDA.

Strategy AI consultancy. Senior AI leadership embedded in your company full time. Roadmap, build versus buy, architecture review, vendor and model selection, hiring and mentoring, and the shared platform that lets every team build on one governed stack.

HOW TO ENGAGE ME

Production readiness audit Fixed fee, 3 to 4 weeks
The usual starting point. I review your AI system end to end and hand back a written assessment of what is production ready, what will break, what it will cost to run at volume, and an evaluation harness you keep. Delivered by me personally, never handed down to a junior team.

Strategy AI consultancy Full time, monthly retainer
A senior AI leader dedicated to your company. Strategy and roadmap, architecture, vendor and model decisions, review of your team's work, and hands-on building where it moves fastest. Minimum three months.

Delivery engagement Scoped project, quoted per statement of work
Building the thing. Typically follows an audit, so the scope is grounded in evidence rather than a guess.

Pricing on request: me@mikew.io

WORKING TOGETHER

- **No visa, no sponsorship, no employment relationship.** I contract and invoice as an independent German business. All work is performed in Germany, so there is no US or Canadian work authorization question and no withholding. Form W-8BEN provided on request.
- **East coast friendly hours.** I work 11:00 to 20:00 Berlin time, which is 05:00 to 14:00 in New York, giving five hours of overlap. Work also lands before your standup, because my morning is your night.
- **Async by default.** Written decision memos, recorded walkthroughs and thorough pull request descriptions, so progress is visible without a meeting.
- **Payment.** USD by domestic ACH transfer, net 15 to net 30.

BACKGROUND

MSc Artificial Intelligence, University of Edinburgh. Seven years across production machine learning, autonomous driving perception and AI leadership. First place, Autonomous Driving Competition, Formula Student UK 2019, and first place, Microsoft hackathon on retrieval-augmented generation. Fluent English, native Spanish.

The next step is a 30 minute call. Tell me what you are trying to ship and what is in the way. If I am not the right person I will say so on that call. me@mikew.io